BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

My tests and treatment checks

Routine safety tests, symptom-driven tests and response scans have different purposes.

Check	Before starting	Treatment visits	Between visits	Next cycle / phase	After treatment
Blood and organ checks	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review medicines, allergies, weight, oral intake and symptoms. Review nerve symptoms and hearing; audiology when indicated. Cisplatin eligibility includes adequate kidney function.	Day 1: full blood count, kidney and liver tests. Day 8: full blood count and creatinine. Hearing assessment and measured kidney clearance are arranged when indicated.	Extra tests may be needed for symptoms or abnormal results.	Review results, recovery and earlier toxicity before another dose.	The team follows recovery, response and persistent side effects. Scans and tumour tests follow the individual plan; there is no universal scan or tumour-marker schedule in this regimen.
Treatment and appointments	Confirm the complete treatment plan.	Gemcitabine runs over 30 minutes, followed on Day 1 by cisplatin over 2 hours. Cisplatin requires prescribed fluids before and after treatment. Day 8 is gemcitabine alone.	Follow written medicine and contact instructions.	Confirm the full treatment sequence and any separate radiotherapy plan. The linked National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) document gives 4–6 cycles; this is not the three-cycle 00903 induction schedule.	Record completion and the named follow-up team.
Mouth, weight and swallowing	Assess symptoms, teeth, eating and drinking.	Review weight, intake and mouth symptoms.	Call for difficulty swallowing, worsening pain or weight loss.	Dietitian and swallowing support according to need.	Continue rehabilitation and dental care if advised.

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. NCCP 00517 v2: retrieved official regimen

Tests in your plan

Full blood count

WHEN

Before each treatment.

Checks infection-fighting cells, oxygen-carrying cells and platelets for clotting.

Kidney and liver tests

WHEN

Day 1: full blood count, kidney and liver tests. Day 8: full blood count and creatinine. Hearing assessment and measured kidney clearance are arranged when indicated.

Checks treatment handling and organ safety.

Hearing assessment

If part of your plan

WHEN

When clinically indicated.

Assesses existing or new hearing changes and tinnitus.

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Gemcitabine 1250 and cisplatin: nasopharyngeal cancer: treatment and checks

Locally advanced nasopharyngeal cancer; the full treatment strategy is agreed by the multidisciplinary team.

Gemcitabine 1,250 mg/m² on Days 1 and 8, with cisplatin 80 mg/m² on Day 1, every 21 days for 4–6 cycles or until progression or unacceptable side effects.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	Treatment visits	Between visits	Next cycle / phase	After treatment
Blood and organ checks NCCP	Full blood count, kidney and liver tests; review medicines, allergies, weight, oral intake and symptoms. Review nerve symptoms and hearing; audiology when indicated. Cisplatin eligibility includes adequate kidney function.	Day 1: full blood count, kidney and liver tests. Day 8: full blood count and creatinine. Hearing assessment and measured kidney clearance are arranged when indicated.	Extra tests may be needed for symptoms or abnormal results.	Review results, recovery and earlier toxicity before another dose.	The team follows recovery, response and persistent side effects. Scans and tumour tests follow the individual plan; there is no universal scan or tumour-marker schedule in this regimen.

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Mouth, weight and swallowing NCCP	Assess symptoms, teeth, eating and drinking.	Review weight, intake and mouth symptoms.	Call for difficulty swallowing, worsening pain or weight loss.	Dietitian and swallowing support according to need.	Continue rehabilitation and dental care if advised.

What each check is for

1 Treatment course

Day 1: both drugs; Day 8: gemcitabine. Every 21 days, 4–6 cycles.

The medicines act together to shrink or control nasopharyngeal cancer. Your team records how this course fits any planned radiation treatment and your overall treatment aim.

Ask / act: Confirm active medicines, safety checks and support plan.

Sources: NCCP

2 Review / next phase

After the planned course and recovery review

Review response and recovery.

Ask / act: Confirm actual dates and the next prescription.

Sources: NCCP

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-11 · Source reconciled draft; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.49